

# File index — what every file is, and when to open it

**All five workbooks are now real Excel Tables.** Every sheet has sticky filter buttons with a search box in each dropdown, banded rows, frozen identity columns, and single-line rows so a screen shows ~30 programmes instead of 6. Click any header arrow to filter or search that column.

Everything produced by this search, in one table. **PDFs are in [pdf/](#) ; spreadsheets and markdown are in [results/](#) .**

## Tier 1 — read these

| File                                    | Size                    | What's in it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Open it when                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>THE - COMPLETE - GUIDE . pdf</b>     | 515 lines               | <b>The whole search explained.</b> 1,091 opportunities · 56 countries. How the "chance of acceptance" column works and how it was validated · the 18 verified WORTH IT options · the accreditation trap in each country · the two separate tests (accreditation vs contact hours) that decide a visa · country-by-country cost table · the Italian DSU scholarship finding · scholarship comparison · your deadline calendar · what to do in the next month · an honest limits section                                                                                                                                                                | <b>First. Before anything else.</b> It is the map for every other file                                                        |
| <b>MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx</b>    | 3.8 MB · <b>20 tabs</b> | <b>Every opportunity found, merged from all five searches.</b> 1,091 rows × 37 columns. Column D now says whether each record is a <b>real master's degree</b> . Tabs: <i>START HERE · BEST BETS · Master's degrees only (889) · NOT a degree — avoid (145) · Strong + English or French · Fully funded · Has a scholarship · Scholarship index · Free or cheap · Everything</i> · then one per region (Western Europe, Southern Europe, Central Europe, Nordics & Baltics, Balkans & Türkiye, Eastern Europe & Caucasus, North America, Asia-Pacific, MENA). Colour-coded on qualification level, chance, cost, language, public/private and funding | <b>Whenever you want to decide something.</b> Start on BEST BETS (116 real degrees), then filter <i>Master's degrees only</i> |
| <b>SOUND - and - SCHOLARSHIPS .xlsx</b> | 27 tabs                 | <b>Only the sound side, plus every scholarship — and now degrees only.</b> 460 sound programmes that award a real master's (audio engineering 209, sound design/production 208, music tech 43), with the 335 music-business and 193 adjacent rows removed, and 64 certificates moved to their own tab. Tabs: <i>* Best bets (64) · one per track · No portfolio needed · Fully funded (68) · Sound + a scholarship · All scholarships (335) · Scholarship index (308 schemes) · NOT a degree — avoid · Award unclear — ask them</i> · * one per country                                                                                               | You want the sound options and the funding in one place, without the business noise                                           |

| File                       | Size      | What's in it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Open it when                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>DEGREE-CHECK.pdf</b>    | 303 lines | <b>"Is it actually a master's degree?"</b> The verdict on all 1,091 records: <b>889 real degrees, 145 not</b> . The look-alike in every country ( <i>título propio</i> , <i>Master di I livello</i> , <i>pós-graduação</i> , CRKBO) and how to verify each against the national register. Plus the full list of the 145 to avoid, with the reason for each | <b>Before you pay any institution.</b> Especially a private one, and especially in Spain or Italy               |
| <b>PATHS-DEEP-DIVE.pdf</b> | 336 lines | <b>What you'd actually study and become.</b> The three career paths — sound & music tech, sound design & production, music business — explained in depth: the modules, the daily reality, the job you end up doing, and what each does <i>not</i> teach. Plus a full explanation of what a portfolio means in practice and how to build one                | <b>Before you choose a direction.</b> The other files tell you <i>where</i> ; this tells you <i>what toward</i> |

## Tier 2 — the three regional deep dives

| File                                          | Size                                | What's in it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Open it when                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>EUROPE-GAPFILL.pdf</b> + <b>.xlsx</b>      | 329 lines · 706 KB · <b>31 tabs</b> | <b>104 institutions the earlier searches missed</b> , in 26 countries, searched in every local language. Contains your two best-rated options — <b>TU Ilmenau</b> and <b>HfK Bremen</b> . Documents that most German states charge non-EU students <b>no tuition at all</b> , that French public masters are a flat <b>€3,950</b> , and that Greece charges <b>no non-EU differential</b> . Spreadsheet has a tab per country plus <i>No Portfolio Needed · English-taught · Free or Cheap</i>               | You want cheap or free public options, or a specific country    |
| <b>PRIVATE-SCHOOLS.pdf</b> + <b>.xlsx</b>     | 461 lines · 906 KB · 9 tabs         | <b>The "don't get scammed" document.</b> 198 private institutions in Spain, Portugal, Netherlands, Italy — accreditation checked first. Which "Masters" are <b>not degrees</b> ( <i>título propio</i> , CRKBO diploma, <i>Master di I livello</i> ) · why the Netherlands is <b>structurally closed</b> to you · the <b>Italian DSU scholarship</b> worth €5,776–€8,134/yr at private academies · Saint Louis Rome. Spreadsheet tabs: <i>Official Only · Worth It · AVOID · Everything · one per country</i> | Before you pay any private institution a single euro            |
| <b>SOUND-DESIGN-EUROPE.pdf</b> + <b>.xlsx</b> | 125 lines · 589 KB · 8 tabs         | <b>The deep dive into your core subject.</b> 319 programmes across every European country — conservatoires, film schools, private academies. The A-list of 13. Spreadsheet tabs: <i>A-LIST · All Programmes · No Audition · Accepts Non-Music · Fully Funded · By Country · Full Detail</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | You want to go deep on sound design and production specifically |

## Tier 3 — planning and honesty

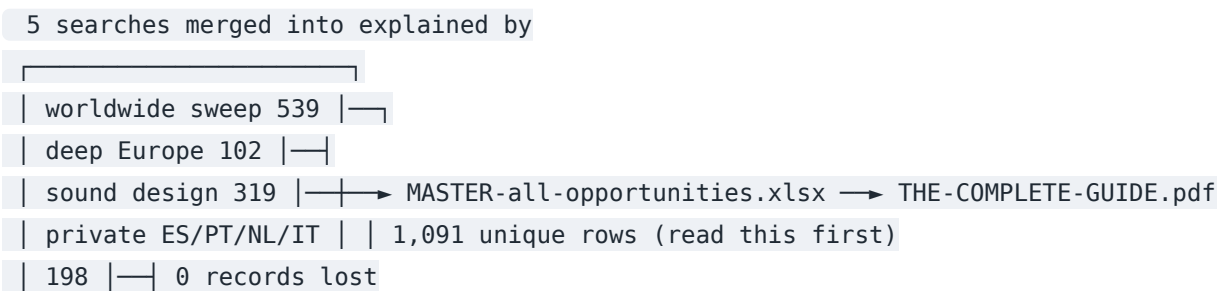
| File                              | Size      | What's in it                                                                                                                                                             | Open it when                                                   |
|-----------------------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>ACTION-TIMELINE.pdf</code>  | 76 lines  | Month-by-month plan from now to September 2027 — portfolio milestones, language study, test dates, document preparation, application windows                             | You're ready to plan the year                                  |
| <code>SHORTLIST.pdf</code>        | 130 lines | The earlier ranked shortlist of 12–15 programmes, each with its study location, fit score and reasoning                                                                  | You want a short, opinionated list rather than a database      |
| <code>COULD-NOT-VERIFY.pdf</code> | 31 lines  | <b>Everything I could not confirm</b> , listed openly — figures no institution publishes, dates that only exist for the prior cycle, claims that need an email to settle | Before you rely on any single number. This is the honesty file |
| <code>README.md</code>            | 20 lines  | Short index of the folder                                                                                                                                                | You're browsing the repo                                       |

## Tier 4 — raw data and earlier snapshots

| File                             | Size                       | What's in it                                                                                                                                            | Open it when                                 |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <code>opportunities.xlsx</code>  | 1.1 MB · 546 rows · 9 tabs | The <b>original worldwide sweep</b> dataset, with its own fit-score and admission-difficulty columns. Superseded by the master file but kept intact     | You want the first sweep on its own terms    |
| <code>europe-gapfill.xlsx</code> | 706 KB · 31 tabs           | (also listed in Tier 2)                                                                                                                                 | —                                            |
| <code>console.html</code>        | 3.4 MB                     | An interactive browser for the same 1,091 records — filter, star, compare. Kept for completeness; the documents and workbooks above carry the same data | You'd rather click than scroll a spreadsheet |

Everything is Excel now — the CSV duplicates were removed, and the raw JSON moved to `.masters-search/results/`. No data was lost: every CSV's rows were confirmed present in its workbook before deletion.

## How the files relate



| Europe gap sweep 104 | — |

1,262 raw records each search also kept its own report:

EUROPE-GAPFILL · PRIVATE-SCHOOLS · SOUND-DESIGN-EUROPE

The three regional reports hold **more per-record detail** than the master file carries — full verification notes, complete fee breakdowns, portfolio specifications. The master file is for **deciding**; the regional files are for **checking a specific programme in depth**.

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## If you only have 20 minutes

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1. THE-COMPLETE-GUIDE.pdf the sections "**First: is it actually a master's degree?**" and "**What verification actually found**"
2. MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx tab \*\* BEST BETS (**already degrees-only**) filter Taught in = English or French\*\*

That is your real shortlist.